

Physics in Formula 1 Racing

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My name is Hoysal B Gowda, and I study at Christ School in Hunsur. Most of my friends know that my absolute favorite sport in the world is playing football, and I also love cricket! On the football ground, I love running fast, kicking the ball, and trying to score goals. But whenever I turn on the TV to watch racing, there is only one sport that gets me excited: Formula 1! My favorite driver is Max Verstappen, who drives car number 1 for the Red Bull team. Max is the fastest driver in the world right now. What I like most about him is that he is super brave. On the track, he plays to win, just like an aggressive football striker going straight for the goal! He never gives up, he never gets scared, and he passes other cars with pure power. The coolest part is that Max uses the exact same sports science that we use in football and in our 7th standard science class to win his races.

First, let us talk about high speed. In science class, we learn that speed is how fast something moves. In my town Hunsur, cars and buses go slowly, around 40 or 50 kilometers per hour. When we play football, even a fast shot from a player goes only so fast. But Max Verstappen drives his Red Bull car at over 350 kilometers per hour! That is much faster than a train. When you blink your eyes, his car has already gone very far. To go that fast, his car speeds up like a rocket when he presses the gas pedal. But when he reaches a sharp turn, he has to slow down fast. He steps hard on the brake pedal, and the car slows down in just two seconds. Going from super fast to slow at every turn takes a lot of strength, sharp focus, and brave thinking.

Next, let us look at friction and heat. In class, our teacher told us that friction is the rubbing force between two things. In football, friction is what helps our football shoes grip the grass ground so we do not fall down while turning. If you rub your hands together fast in winter, your hands feel warm because of friction! The exact same thing happens to Max's car tires. When the big rubber tires roll on the track, they rub against the road. This rubbing makes the tires super hot. When the tires get hot, the rubber becomes soft and sticky. Sticky tires hold the road tightly, just like good studs on a football boot grip the turf. This holding power keeps the car from sliding off the track during fast turns. Before the race starts, Max turns his car left and right quickly. He zig-zags to rub the tires on the ground so they get hot, sticky, and ready to grip the road.

Max uses his smart brain. He looks for dry spots on the road where there is still some friction left. He turns his steering wheel softly so his tires do not spin out. He passes other cars easily in the rain! It looks like magic, but it is just smart driving and simple science.

I love Max because he has the spirit of a true sports champion. Just like in a tough football match, a race driver needs to think fast and stay focused. When Max puts on his helmet, he only thinks about winning. It does not matter if he starts in the front or behind; he tries his best in every single lap. He pushes his car to the limit. If another driver tries to overtake him, Max blocks them bravely. He shows no fear to anyone on the track, and that is why he is a true champion.

Some people think Formula 1 is just cars driving in circles, but now you know it is much more than that! It is full of speed, courage, and real science. Every turn needs friction, every long road needs high speed, and every rainy lap tests how drivers handle slippery roads. Nobody uses science on the track better than Max Verstappen.

I am very happy to study at Christ School, Hunsur. Learning science in class and playing sports on the field helps me understand Formula 1 so much better. Science is not just words in a textbook—it is fast, loud, and exciting! Max Verstappen is my hero and the king of speed. Go Red Bull, and go Max!